(c) Emergency federal acts that are not based on a provision of the constitution.

The following are submitted to a vote of the people:

(a) Popular initiatives for a total revision of the constitution.

(b) Popular initiatives for a partial revision of the constitution in the form of a general proposal that have been rejected by the Federal Assembly.

(c) The question of whether a total revision of the constitution should be carried out, in the event that there is disagreement between the two chambers of the Federal Assembly.

(ii) Optional Referendum: If 50,000 voters or eight cantons request it, the following are submitted to a vote of the people:

(a) Federal acts.

(b) Emergency federal acts whose term of validity exceeds one year.

(c) Federal decrees, if the constitution or an act so requires.

(d) International treaties of specified categories.

Under the constitution, the device of initiative is allowed, at the federal level, only in the case of constitutional amendments and not in the case of federal laws or international treaties.

Any 1,00,000 voters may propose a total revision of the constitution. Similarly, any 1,00,000 voters may request a partial revision of the constitution. A popular initiative for the partial revision of the constitution may take the form of a general proposal (i.e., unformulative initiative) or of a specific draft of the provisions proposed (i.e., formulative initiative).

7. Triple Citizenship Under the Swiss constitution, the citizenship is three-fold, i.e., the citizenship of the commune (municipality), the canton and the federation. The constitution declares that any person who is a citizen of a commune and of the canton to which that commune belongs, is a Swiss citizen. This means that no person can be a citizen of Switzerland without being a citizen of a canton and no person can be a citizen of a canton without being a citizen of a commune. In Switzerland, the communal citizenship is regarded as more valuable than the cantonal and federal citizenship.

8. Fundamental Rights The Swiss constitution contains an elaborate list of fundamental rights of the citizens. They include civil, social, economic, political and personal rights. These are mentioned below:

(i) Protection of human dignity

(ii) Right to equality before the law

(iii) Protection against arbitrary conduct and principle of good faith

(iv) Right to life and to personal freedom

(v) Protection of children and young people

(vi) Right to assistance when in need